Åbo Akademi

PRIVACY NOTICE

Processing of Personal Data in Research
PHRED – Pharmacy-Counseling by Health Retrieval & Evidence-Driven Dialogue Framework

In accordance with the General Data Protection Regulation (EU) 2016/679

Data Controller

Åbo Akademi University is the data controller for the processing of personal data in this study.
Åbo Akademi University
Domkyrkotorget 3
20500 Turku
Finland

2. Contact Persons

Project Contact Person
Prashani Jayasingha
Email: prashani.jayasinghaarachchige@abo.fi

Data Protection Officer
Email: dataskydd@abo.fi
Phone: +358 2 215 31 (switchboard)

3. Purpose of the Processing and Description of the Study
The purpose of this study is to investigate how a digital system can support medication counselling and how users experience interaction with such a system.

The PHRED project explores how digital and human-like dialogue systems can provide guidance about medications, with a particular focus on human–computer interaction in everyday use.

You participate in the role of a pharmacy customer by having an online conversation with the PHRED system. The study evaluates:

- Ease of use of the system
- Clarity of the provided information
- Perceived usefulness of the interaction

The collected data will be used to create a research dataset and for scientific publications and presentations. All data will be handled in a way that protects your identity.

4. Legal Basis for Processing

The legal basis for processing your personal data under Article 6 of the GDPR is:
Task carried out in the public interest (scientific research).
Participation is voluntary, and informed consent is collected before participation.

5. Categories of Personal Data Processed

The following data may be processed:

- Transcribed text from the system conversation
- Questionnaire responses
- Technical interaction logs (stored in JSON format)
- Indirect identifiers that may appear unintentionally during interaction

No personal data is intentionally collected. If personal data appears unintentionally, it will be removed or pseudonymised.
No biometric data (face, voice, or video) is collected in this study.

6. How the Study Is Conducted

- You will interact with the PHRED system online as a pharmacy customer
- The conversation will be recorded as text-based interaction data
- The interaction will be stored in a technical research format (JSON)
- After participation, you will receive a questionnaire to be completed within three (3) days

Estimated time commitment:

- Conversation: 10–20 minutes
- Questionnaire: 10–15 minutes

7. Who Has Access to the Data

Only members of the PHRED research project at Åbo Akademi University have access to the data.
The data will not be disclosed to third parties. If shared for scientific collaboration, it will only be in fully pseudonymised form and under strict data protection agreements.

8. Transfer of Data Outside the EU/EEA

Your personal data will not be transferred outside the EU/EEA. All data is stored on secure servers within Åbo Akademi University.
If any cloud-based tools are used for system operation, no identifiable personal data will be transferred.

9. Storage and Retention of Data

- Research data is stored securely on Åbo Akademi University servers
- Data is accessible only to authorized researchers
- Pseudonymised research data will be stored for five (5) years after project completion
- After the retention period, data will be permanently deleted

10. Your Rights as a Data Subject

Under the GDPR, you have the right to:

- Receive information about how your data is processed
- Access your personal data
- Have incorrect data corrected
- Have your data erased in certain situations
- Restrict processing in certain cases
- Object to processing
- Lodge a complaint with a data protection authority

Please note that some rights may be limited when data is processed for scientific research.

11. How to Exercise Your Rights

You can contact the Data Protection Officer at Åbo Akademi University:
Email: dataskydd@abo.fi
General instructions on data protection rights:
https://www.abo.fi/dataskydd/

12. Voluntary Participation and Withdrawal

Participation is completely voluntary. You may:

- Stop at any time
- Decline to answer any question
- Withdraw your participation without giving a reason

If you withdraw, your data will be deleted whenever possible and there will be no negative consequences.

13. Data Protection Authority

Office of the Data Protection Ombudsman (Finland)
P.O. Box 800
FI-00531 Helsinki
Finland
Phone: +358 29 566 6700